LakeHub
TECHIES & CREATIVES

Zone 01
Kisumu

QUARTER 2 IMPACT REPORT

April, May and June 2026



ABOUT LAKEHUB



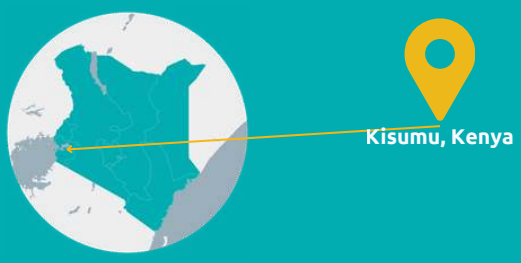
Vision

L**akehub** was founded with the belief that investing in tech education and development of Africa's youth is essential for the growth and progress of the continent, and it is committed to providing the resources and support that these young people need to reach their full potential.

Through Zone01 Kisumu, we provide youths from all backgrounds with an opportunity to learn software development from scratch through peer-to-peer activities after which, they are guaranteed employment.

Mission

Our mission is to **decentralize access to technology tools and resources**, making them readily available to young people in underserved areas. By providing comprehensive tech education, mentorship programs, and access to cutting-edge technology, we equip young individuals with the skills and resources necessary to succeed in a digital economy



NOTE FROM THE CO-EXECUTIVE DIRECTORS

Ladies and Gentlemen,

This quarter has been a reminder that meaningful change is often built through many small moments: an opportunity created, a barrier removed, a partnership formed, a learner taking a chance on themselves. When I look back on the last few months, I see all of these moments coming together to create something truly exciting.

One of the highlights of the quarter has been the strengthening of our partnership ecosystem. We were delighted to welcome the Dawn Wade Foundation as a partner in our journey. This partnership represents more than financial support; they are a vote of confidence in the potential of young people across our region and in the impact that can be achieved when opportunity meets talent.

The support from the Dwyane Wade Foundation marks another exciting milestone as we continue to expand the network of organizations investing in youth-led innovation, skills development, and economic opportunity.

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At Zone01 Kisumu, we continue to see incredible momentum. Our first cohort has demonstrated what is possible when talent is given the right environment to thrive, and we are now focused on expanding access to even more young people.

This quarter, **we launched our first women-only Piscine, an important step toward addressing the gender gap in technology and creating more pathways for women to enter the digital economy.**

The enthusiasm, determination, and talent displayed by the participants have been inspiring and serve as a powerful reminder of why intentional efforts to increase inclusion matter.

The campus has also been alive with activity through a series of hackathons and innovation challenges. If you've ever walked through Zone01 during a hackathon, you'll know it is equal parts creativity, collaboration, determination, and controlled chaos.

Teams have spent hours building solutions, testing ideas, and pushing the boundaries of what they thought was possible. These experiences are helping develop not only technical skills but also the resilience, teamwork, and problem-solving abilities needed to succeed in today's workforce.

Beyond Kenya, this quarter also presented opportunities to build new relationships across the globe. **Through engagements with partners in South America, we explored shared challenges, exchanged ideas, and began conversations that could lead to future collaborations.** It was encouraging to discover how many of the challenges facing young people are universal and how much can be gained through cross-border learning and partnership.

As always, our work extends beyond any single program or project. Whether through skills development, entrepreneurship support, innovation programs, or ecosystem building, we remain committed to creating opportunities for young people to learn, grow, and lead.

To our learners, staff, partners, funders, and supporters, thank you for being part of this journey. Every milestone we celebrate is the result of a collective effort, and every success story reflects the power of community, collaboration, and belief in human potential.

As we move into the next quarter, we do so with optimism, ambition, and a renewed commitment to expanding access, deepening impact, and ensuring that more young people have the opportunity to shape their own futures.

Dorcas Owino & Caleb Nyoiro
Co-Executive Directors

ZONE01 KISUMU COHORT 2 IN NUMBERS

Since kicking off Zone01 Kisumu Cohort 2 in January 2026, **we have selected 127 apprentices to join our our apprenticeship program. Currently, 100 of them are in active training. Of these, 23 are women**, underscoring our deliberate effort to expand access to tech careers for underrepresented groups, even as we continue to push for greater gender parity in future intakes.

Within the first six months of the training, 5 apprentices have already been placed in employment representing a meaningful early signal of our program's labour market relevance. Notably, 2 of the 5 placed candidates are women, affirming that our focus on inclusion is translating into real economic outcomes for women in the region.

The **apprentices placed in employment are earning an average of KES 65,000 per month**. These wages sit well above the local average entry level roles and speak directly to the quality and market alignment of the technical training we provide.

These figures represent households transformed, career trajectories redirected, and a growing proof point that Zone01 Kisumu's, peer-driven tech education can produce talent that employers are ready to hire and pay well.

Interviewed in Piscines
812

Selected to join Cohort 2
127

Women Selected to join Cohort 2
23

Cohort 2 Placed In jobs
5/100 DEVS

Cohort 2 Average Earnings
$502



IMPACT-DRIVEN COLLABORATION: HOSTING PARTNERS FOR EQUITY (PFE) @ ZONE01 KISUMU

On 24th June 2026, Partners For Equity's Lenah Gideon and Eveline Shilwatso visited LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu to connect and engage directly with Zone01 Kisumu Cohort II learners and staff. Partners for Equity (PFE) has been a key partner of LakeHub Foundation since 2018, supporting our mission to equip young people with the skills, opportunities, and networks needed for meaningful careers and sustainable livelihoods.

Our Impact to Date

PFE's support has underpinned some of LakeHub Foundation's major programs for eight years now. **LakeHub Academy, a tuition-free, industry-aligned digital skills training program, graduated over 600 young people,** connecting underserved youth in Kisumu to employment, freelance work, and entrepreneurship opportunities across local and international tech ecosystems. **The FemiDevs Program, run across multiple cohorts, graduated 200 young women, of whom 100 secured entry-level tech positions.** Insights from these and other programs across the past decade directly informed the design of Zone01 Kisumu, LakeHub Foundation's current flagship initiative.

Cohort Engagement and Outcomes

During the visit, Lenah and Eveline engaged with Zone01 Kisumu's Cohort 2 apprentices and observed the program's peer-to-peer learning model firsthand. We also discussed ways in which we can build on the successful employment outcomes of Zone01 Kisumu Cohort 1 that has so far placed 73 of 76 apprentices in jobs.

"PFE's commitment is rooted in a simple but powerful belief, that resources should be directed to locally led initiatives that understand their communities and are best positioned to create lasting change. We've seen real impact, especially on incomes, for youths at Zone01 Kisumu"

- Lenah Gideon, Program Manager, Partners For Equity.





MICHELLE WANJIRU LEADING BY EXAMPLE

When Michelle Wanjiru (centre) joined Zone01 Kisumu, her goal was simple. Learn how to code. She's leaving Zone01 Kisumu with more than just code.

Fresh from the university but without a job, she discovered our transformative learning experience that extends far beyond software development.

Through Zone01 Kisumu's project-based, peer-to-peer learning model, Michelle developed technical expertise alongside leadership, collaboration, resilience, and problem-solving skills.

Like many apprentices, Michelle navigated demanding deadlines, complex projects, intensive audits, and long hours debugging code. These challenges strengthened her confidence, adaptability, and ability to tackle difficult problems. skills that would later prove valuable in the workplace.

From the onset, Michelle's leadership qualities stood out. She served as an Events Coordinator, helping organize mini-conferences, workshops, and community events that connected apprentices with professionals, mentors, and industry leaders.

She also recorded and produced Whats New In Tech YouTube series, talking about new tech trends and innovations. These experiences expanded her professional network and helped her develop strong communication, organizational, and leadership skills.

Today, halfway through her 12-month tech training at Zone01 Kisumu, **Michelle has landed employment as a Software Developer at Professional Digital Systems Ltd, with a starting salary of KSh 50,000 per month**.

Her transition from unemployment to a professional technology role demonstrates the life-changing potential of accessible, high-quality technology education. Michelle is determined to complete the learning module as she intended when she joined Zone01 Kisumu.

Michelle's journey reflects the broader impact of Zone01 Kisumu in equipping young people with the skills, confidence, and opportunities needed to participate meaningfully in the digital economy.







STRENGTHENING PARTNERSHIPS FOR TALENT VISIBILITY

LakeHub Foundation and Zone01 Kisumu hosted Susan M. Burns, Chargé d'Affaires at the U.S. Embassy in Kenya.

The visit provided an opportunity to showcase the growth of the technology ecosystem in Western Kenya and highlight the impact of LakeHub's work in developing technology talent and expanding access to digital opportunities for young people.

*"It is wonderful to see this kind of talent in Kisumu. We can find a pathway that connects companies in the United States to you" — **Susan M. Burns, CDA, US-Embassy Nairobi***

The visit elevated the visibility of Zone01 Kisumu's emerging tech talent and reinforced the importance of international partnerships in advancing digital economic growth.

It also created an opportunity to explore potential areas of collaboration between Kenyan and U.S. stakeholders in technology talent development and innovation.



During the visit, Zone01 Kisumu apprentices and alumni engaged directly with the delegation, demonstrating software development projects and technology solutions they have built through the program.

Discussions with LakeHub leadership highlighted the organization's journey in building a thriving innovation ecosystem that serves young people across Western Kenya and beyond.

LakeHub Foundation will continue cultivating partnerships that expand opportunities for technology talent, strengthen innovation ecosystems, and connect local entrepreneurs and developers to regional and global networks.

Cover Image: Emmaculate Odhiambo, Cohort 2 Apprentice speaks to US Embassy Kenya Charge d'Affaires Susan M. Burns



ZONE01 KISUMU @ FEIRA PRETA FESTIVAL IN SÃO PAULO AND RIO DE JANEIRO

LakeHub Foundation's Co-Executive Director, Dorcas Owino, and Head of Tech, Paul Oguda, participated in a series of international engagements in Brazil and Spain, joining innovators, policymakers, entrepreneurs, researchers, and community leaders to explore solutions to challenges in technology, finance, education, and community development.

São Paulo, Brazil - AfroCapital Hack
Dorcas and Paul led discussions on Trust, Credit, and Building Inclusive Systems drawing on Kenya's nascent mobile money, credit, and micro-lending ecosystem. **They also spoke about the innovations that have arisen from LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu that are community-led, and currently helping expand financial inclusion**. These discussions reinforced the importance of designing solutions that are rooted in community needs and realities.

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil - Community as Infrastructure
While in Rio, LakeHub's experiences in building technology talent and entrepreneurial ecosystems in Kisumu were featured in conversations with global stakeholders, highlighting the growing recognition of locally driven innovation models from Africa. **The engagements facilitated valuable knowledge exchange on youth empowerment, and community-led development**.

Based on the outcomes of the discussions, **Zone01 Kisumu is leading, and actively pursuing, collaboration projects on digital lending, alternative credit scoring, and financial literacy for global south markets to reduce the risks of excluding communities that have long been ignored by existing systems**.

Cover Image: Zone01 Kisumu's Dorcas Owinoh (top row, left) and Paul Oguda (top row, centre) at the Feira Preta Festival Hackathon



(Left) Laís Rocha, experienced Social Innovation, Impact Investment, and ESG guru with Zone01 Kisumu, Co-Executive Director (Right)



Paul Oguda, Zone01 Kisumu's Head of Tech leads a discussions on Trust, Credit, and Building Inclusive Systems using lessons drawn from Kenya.

ZONE01KISUMU AND NATION.DEV PARTNER TO CONNECT TALENT TO GLOBAL JOBS

As the global technology landscape ships, partnerships that connect emerging talent to real-world opportunities are becoming increasingly important. **In Q2, Nation.dev Co-Founder and CEO Juan Carlos Mauritz visited Zone01 Kisumu for a landmark engagement focused on the future of software engineering and global tech collaboration**.

This visit saw the signing of a partnership agreement between LakeHub and Nation.dev, a collaboration aimed at strengthening pathways for Zone01 Kisumu's software engineering talent to access global opportunities, industry exposure, and future-proofed skills development.

LakeHub Co-Executive Director, Dorcas Owinoh said, "Our partnership with Nation.dev ensures that our apprentices access global roles in software development. We are proud to join an impressive list of talent partners that Nation.dev is already working with."

As part of the visit, Juan Carlos Mauritz delivered a tech talk to Zone01 Kisumu apprentices titled "***The Future of the Software Engineer in the Age of AI***." The session explored how artificial intelligence is reshaping software development, the evolving role of engineers, and the importance of adaptability, creativity, and systems thinking in the modern tech industry.

Juan Carlos said, "Artificial Intelligence will lower the barrier to entry for software developers as well as make them more efficient. This means that software developers will concentrate on their primary job of connecting dots and solving problems"

Our partnership with Nation.dev reflects our shared vision, building world-class, AI-ready tech talent and connecting young developers to the global job market.





DIGIKEN PROJECT :UN WOMEN AND ACTS PARTNERS VISIT LAKEHUB

LakeHub has onboarded 260 trainees and 20 MSMEs currently receiving digital skills literacy training on the Digiken Learning Management System platform





LakeHub Foundation hosted an official monitoring visit by UN Women and ACTS Partners as part of the DigiKen Programme. During the visit, the team engaged with learners, and interacted with MSME beneficiaries who shared testimonials and demonstrated how the program has supported their businesses and digital growth.

Digiken Programme equips beneficiaries and MSMEs with foundational digital skills literacy to improve employability, entrepreneurship, and participation in the digital economy. So far, **LakeHub has onboarded 260 trainees and 20 MSMEs on to the Digiken LMS platform against a target of 530 participants.**

The visit provided an opportunity to showcase programme progress and validate the impact of digital skills training on women, youth, and small business owners. It also reinforced the importance of partnerships in advancing digital inclusion and economic empowerment.

What's Next?
LakeHub Foundation will continue working with UN Women and ACTS Partners to expand access to digital skills training. We've and strengthen economic opportunities for women, youth, and MSMEs across the region.



ZONE01 KISUMU HOSTS THE BIGGEST BITCOIN LIGHTNING DEVELOPER BOOTCAMP ACROSS AFRICA

For an entire week in June, LakeHub Foundation and Zone01 Kisumu hosted the largest Lightning Developer Bootcamp held in Africa to date. The bootcamp saw 105 software developers sign up for an intensive week of learning, collaboration, and hands-on development focused on Bitcoin and the Lightning Network.



The bootcamp combined technical training, mentorship, and practical project development. The developers deepened their understanding of the lightning network, emerging financial technologies connected to the network and open-source development.

"*As digital financial systems continue to evolve, there is a growing need for developers with the skills to build secure, scalable, and locally relevant solutions. We came all the way from Nigeria and Uganda to witness this historic bootcamp. We've never seen such a turnout of developers - especially given Kisumu is not a capital city,*" remarked Brindon Mwiine from AfricaFree Routing and Gorilla Sats.



A major highlight of the bootcamp was the final day hackathon, where participants applied their newly acquired skills to develop real-world solutions. **In just a few days, participants formed 16 teams and developed 16 projects, alongside one individual project.**

The quality of the demonstrations reflected significant technical growth and showcased the creativity and potential of local developers. The bootcamp was further enriched by contributions from mentors, guest speakers and judges including UN-Women representatives, and ecosystem partners who shared knowledge and industry perspectives throughout the week.

Zone01 Kisumu has strengthened Kisumu's position as a growing hub for technology talent and emerging digital innovation.

Q2 EVENTS AT ZONE01 KISUMU



OSI-TCP Mini Conference

In April 2026, Zone01 Kisumu apprentices hosted the Open Systems Interconnection (OSI) and Transmission Control Protocol/Internet Protocol (TCP/IP) Mini Conference, exploring networking fundamentals, cybersecurity, and how data moves across network layers.

The conference taught the apprentices to share knowledge, strengthen technical skills, and engage in peer-to-peer learning while deepening their understanding of modern network systems.



Frontend Frameworks Conference

The evolution of frontend development and popular tools including React, Vue.js, Svelte, and Alpine.js requires developers to adjust fast to market needs.

The Frontend Frameworks meet up explored framework selection as well as a hands-on Alpine.js workshop that strengthened participants' practical development skills through collaborative project building and peer learning. Keynote sessions were conducted by Elizabeth Omitto, Silas Kipkosgei and Amon Ochuka



On-Chain Hackathon

Continuing with the theme of introducing apprentices to new cutting-edge technologies, Zone01 Kisumu hosted a Ray Tracing Mini-Conference, introducing participants to the fundamentals of computer graphics and rendering.

Apprentices explored vectors, light transport, reflections, refractions, and rendering techniques, gaining practical insights into how mathematics, physics, and software engineering combine to create realistic digital environments and visual effects.



Ray Tracing Mini Conference

Zone01 Kisumu hosted a Ray Tracing Mini-Conference exploring the science and mathematics behind modern computer graphics. Participants learned about light simulation, rendering techniques, GPU acceleration, and the trade-offs between real-time and offline rendering.

Through practical implementation in Go, apprentices gained hands-on experience applying complex concepts to build realistic digital environments.

STRENGTHENING OUR SAFEGUARDING POLICY



"Safeguarding is not a policy exercise - it is a reflection of institutional culture and leadership commitment. Thank you for your commitment to creating an environment where safety, dignity, respect, and accountability are embedded into the learner experience from the outset." - *Peter Ouma, Safeguarding Advisor and Trainer*

We are proud to share that we successfully completed a safeguarding training for staff and Zone01 Kisumu apprentices to strengthen awareness and reinforce our commitment to providing a safe, respectful, and inclusive learning environment.

The training, conducted by renowned Safeguarding, Governance and HR/People and Culture Advisor, Peter Ouma, equipped participants with the knowledge and practical tools to identify, prevent, and respond appropriately to safeguarding concerns.

Key topics included understanding safeguarding principles, recognizing power dynamics in professional and learning environments, the importance of timely and confidential reporting, and the shared responsibility of maintaining safe spaces for all. Participants were also introduced to appropriate reporting mechanisms and encouraged to take an active role in fostering a culture of accountability and respect.

By investing in safeguarding awareness, we continue to strengthen our organizational culture, ensuring that all learners, staff, and stakeholders can participate in our programs in an environment that prioritizes dignity, wellbeing, and protection.

THE TEAM



Gender Balance

60/40

At the heart of LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu is a team dedicated to empowering youth through transformative tech education. Our team is committed to building a future where opportunity is driven by skills, innovation, and collaboration. We foster a supportive, inclusive environment that nurtures talent and drives lasting social impact across Western Kenya and beyond. We are pleased to add Rodgers Kaunda, a Zone01 Kisumu Cohort 1 trainee, to our staff. He has joined the Tech Team



Dorcas Owinoh
Co-Executive Director



Caleb Nyoiro
Co-Executive Director



Paul Oguda
Head of Tech



Lydiah Ojowi
Finance Manager



Torsten Kremser
Partnerships



Deril Ouko
Comms Lead



Bellah Oyucho
Tech Mentor



Rodgers Kaunda
Tech Mentor



Alpha Omondi
Tech Mentor



Daisy Achieng
Comms Associate

STATEMENT OF EXPENDITURE

For the Quarter Ending 30th June 2026.

As at **30 June 2026**, **funding received was USD 414,461 (87%)** of the approved annual funding requirement. **The funding deficit was USD 59,809 (13%)**.

Total expenditure amounted to USD 266,391 (56%) of the approved annual budget, **leaving USD 207,879 (44%) available** for planned activities in the 2nd half of the year.

	Budget	YTD Actuals	Variance	Variance %
Revenue	**USD**	**USD**		
Grant Inflows		385,895.56		
Other earnings (Project Income)		28,565.85		
Total Revenue	**474,269.92**	414,461.41	-59,808.52	-13%
Expenses				
Program Expenses	287,142	156,553.88	-130,588.3	-45%
Operational Costs	187,128	109,837.13	-77,290.62	-41%
Total Expenses	**474,269.92**	**266,391**	**-207,878.92**	**-44%**



WOMEN IN TECH ROLES SHOULD BE THE NORM

Despite growing interest in digital skills training among young people in Kisumu, women remain significantly underrepresented in technology education and careers. This trend continues to be reflected in our applicant pool and apprentice cohorts. Across our first two cohorts, male applicants and trainees have consistently outnumbered female participants, highlighting the persistent social, cultural, and economic barriers that discourage young women from pursuing technology pathways.

The **Global Gender Gap Report 2023** by the World Economic Forum notes the persistent global underrepresentation of women in IT, especially in managerial and professional roles. The report notes that women only hold 20% of managerial roles and 26.7 % of professional roles in IT. While there's been a slight upturn in women taking up tech roles since, locally, we still face a real challenge in recruiting women interested in joining tech.

To address this challenge, Zone01 Kisumu launched a targeted women-only recruitment campaign during the quarter and launched two dedicated women-only selection piscines in starting in June 2026. The initiatives have been designed to create a more inclusive entry point into tech education for women in Kisumu while addressing confidence, representation, and accessibility barriers that often limit female participation. The response to the selection has been positive. In this regard, we invited **52 out of 296** women who applied to take part in the ongoing selection. **LakeHub's Co-Executive Director, Dorcas Owino hosted a town hall with the women taking part in the selection and has been present at the selection to offer support to the women applicants.**

We've also beefed up safety and accessibility for the female applicants taking part in our selections. Feedback from applicants, their parents, guardians, and staff highlighted the need to prioritize safety without compromising access to our learning facility. Addressing these barriers remains critical to increasing participation and retention among young women.

While early engagement has been encouraging, achieving meaningful gender balance will require sustained outreaches and community engagement, and program support specifically designed to provide access to women and girls joining tech.



THANK YOU!

To all our partners for trusting us with their tremendous and generous financial, in-kind donations, support, collaboration, and jobs that have helped us impact lives in 2026. Without you, every activity we have performed and achieved until now would not have been possible.

Funding Partners

PFE Partners for Equity
Livelihood Impact Fund
Segal Family Foundation
mastercard foundation
UN WOMEN
King Baudouin Foundation
Working together for a better society

Implementing Partners

Talent
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